

Utsubo Sock

Worked toe-up, the famous Moray Eel Sock from designer Chiharu Nagase.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ff_U8l2F3Fg

The pattern has been graded for seven sizes, and the instructions can be worked with any type of sock knitting needles: magic loop, 2 circular needles, or traditional or flexible DPNs.

Transcribed and graded by Kate Atherley, with full permission from the designer and support from Mayu Purayath of Knitters Without Borders, Naoko Ogawa and Jo Fromstein.

MATERIALS:

Approx 60 gm/250 m fingering-weight sock yarn.

Samples uses Opal Sock Yarn
(75% superwash wool, 25% nylon;
425m/465 yds per 100g ball)

a set of 2.5 mm/US #1.5 needles –
traditional or flexible DPNs, a sock-
length circular, two circulars or a long
circular for magic loop, as you prefer

Note: if you wish to work with
traditional straight DPNs, we
recommend starting the cast on
and working the first round or
two with magic loop or two circular needles; if you wish to work with a sock-length circular, you will
need an alternative method for working the toe cast on and increases.

one 3mm (US #2.5) needle – a single DPN or a short circular, for working i-cord edging

2 safety pins or removable stitch markers; 2 other stitch markers

yarn needle

SIZES & FINISHED MEASUREMENTS

Size	XXS	XS	S	M	L	XL	XXL
To Fit: Foot circumference	7.25 inches/ 18.5 cm	7.75 inches/ 19.5 cm	8.25 inches/ 21 cm	8.75 inches/ 22 cm	9.5 inches/ 24 cm	10 inches/ 25.5 cm	10.5 inches/ 26.5 cm
Women's US Shoe Size	3-5	5-7	7½-9	9½-11	12+		
Men's US Shoe Size				4-7	7½-9	9½-11	12+
Finished Sock circumference	6.5 inches/ 16.5 cm	7 inches/ 18 cm	7.5 inches/ 19 cm	8 inches/ 20.5 cm	8.5 inches/ 21.5 cm	9 inches/ 23 cm	9.5 inches/ 24 cm

Socks should stretch to fit. Choose a size with finished circumference approximately .75-1 inch/2-2.5 cm smaller than your foot, measured at the ball of the foot

GAUGE

30 sts and 40 rounds over 4 inches/10 cm square in stockinette stitch using 2.5mm/US #1.5 needles



REFERENCES & TECHNIQUES

Turkish Cast On

<https://holliyeoh.com/tutorial/turkish-cast-on/>

Note: If you're working with a sock-length circular or traditional DPNs, use an alternative method to cast on the toe.

M1R: Insert left needle, from back to front, under strand of yarn which runs between last stitch on left needle and first stitch on right needle; knit this stitch through front loop. 1 st increased.

M1L: Insert left needle, from front to back, under strand of yarn which runs between last stitch on left needle and first stitch on right needle; knit this stitch through back loop. 1 st increased.

SSK: Slip the next 2 stitches, individually, knitwise; return them to left needle and knit them together through back loop. 1 st decreased.

TBL: through back loop.

German Short Rows (Garter Stitch)

Make DS (double stitch): bring the yarn to the front, slip the next stitch purlwise onto the right-hand needle and tug up on yarn so that both legs of the stitch come up onto the needle; then take the yarn over the back of the needle so it's in position for knitting.

To resolve the short rows: just work both legs of the DS together as if they are one stitch.



METHOD

Using the Turkish method, make 8 (10, 10, 12, 14, 14, 16) wraps to CO 16 (20, 20, 24, 28, 28, 32) sts, and knit across the first round.

If you're working with flexible DPNs, magic loop or 2 circulars, ensure your stitches are arranged as follows: 8 (10, 10, 12, 14, 14, 16) sts each on two sides, divided at the center of the round.

If you're working with traditional DPNs, ensure your stitches are arranged across three needles as follows:

The first 8 (10, 10, 12, 14, 14, 16) sts on the first needle, and 4 (5, 5, 6, 7, 7, 8) sts each on the other two.

Place a safety pin or marker in the fabric of the toe near the start of the first needle, to indicate the start of the round, and a second in the fabric at the start of the second half, to indicate the center of the round.

Round 1, increase: K1, m1L, knit to 1 st before center of round, m1R, k1; k1, m1L, knit to 1 st before end of round, m1R, k1. 4 sts increased.

Round 2: Knit.

Repeat *Rounds 1 & 2*, 6 (6, 7, 7, 7, 8, 8) more times, until you have 44 (48, 52, 56, 60, 64, 68) sts total on your needles.

Knit all rounds until sock measures approximately 4.5 (5, 5.25, 5.5, 6, 6.25, 8.5) inches/ 11.5 (12.5, 13.5, 14, 15, 16, 21.5) cm long from the tip of the toe OR 2.75 (3, 3.25, 3.5, 3.5, 4, 4.25) inches/ 7 (7.5, 8.5, 9, 9, 10, 11) cm shorter than actual foot length measured from back of heel to tip of toe.

Shape Gusset

To make this step easier, ensure your stitches are arranged so that the first half of the round is on one needle. These stitches will become the heel.

Gusset round 1: M1L, place marker, knit to end of the heel sts, place marker, m1R; knit to end of round. 2 gusset sts increased.

You will have half the stitches between the two markers, and 1 st each for the gusset outside these markers. As you work the next rounds, keep the increases on the same needle as the heel stitches.

Round 2: Knit around.

Round 3: M1L, k across gusset and heel sts (to the marker for the center of the round), m1R; knit to end of round. 2 gusset sts increased.

Round 4: Knit around.

Repeat *Rounds 3 & 4*, 5 (5, 6, 6, 7, 8, 8) more times. 36 (38, 42, 44, 48, 52, 54) sts on the heel side of the sock; 58 (62, 68, 72, 78, 84, 88) sts total.

Heel Turn

This is worked back and forth in rows, in garter stitch, on the stitches between the heel markers.

Row 1 (RS): Knit to first marker, slip marker, knit to second marker (do not slip it), turn.

Row 2 (WS): Make DS, knit to marker, turn.

Working only on the heel stitches, continue:

Row 3 (RS): Make DS, knit to previous DS (1 st before marker), turn.

Row 4 (WS): Make DS, knit to previous DS (1 st before marker), turn.

Row 5: Make DS, knit to previous DS (2 sts before marker), turn.

Row 6: Make DS, knit to previous DS (2 sts before marker), turn.

Row 7: Make DS, knit to previous DS (3 sts before marker), turn.

Row 8: Make DS, knit to previous DS (3 sts before marker), turn.

Continue as set, working 1 less stitch each row, until you have completed 13 (15, 15, 17, 17, 19, 21) rows, ending with a RS row.

| You will have 6 (7, 7, 8, 8, 9, 10) DSeS on each side.

Heel flap transition row 1 (WS): Make DS, k to previous DS, then purl all the 6 (7, 7, 8, 8, 9, 10) DS to the marker (working into both legs of each DS), turn.

Heel flap transition row 2 (RS): Slip 1 knitwise, k across to marker (working into both legs of each DS), remove marker, turn.

Heel flap transition row 3 (WS): Slip 1 purlwise, purl to marker, remove marker, turn.

Heel Flap

Row 1 (RS): Slip 1 knitwise, (k1, slip 1 purlwise) 10 (11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16) times, SSK, turn. 1 gusset st decreased.

Row 2 (WS): Slip 1 purlwise, p20 (22, 24, 26, 28, 30, 32), p2tog, turn. 1 gusset st decreased.

Repeat *Rows 1 & 2*, 5 (5, 6, 6, 7, 8, 8) more times, until all but one of the gusset stitches on each side have been decreased. 24 (26, 28, 30, 32, 34, 36) sts on the heel. RS will be facing.

Leg – Heel Side

You will continue working on the 22 (24, 26, 28, 30, 32, 34) sts of the heel, decreasing a gusset st each row.

Row 1 (RS): Slip 1 knitwise, (k1, slip 1 purlwise) 10 (11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16) times, SSK, turn. 1 gusset st decreased.

Row 2 (WS): Make DS (*because the previous row ended with a decrease, you will have four strands up on the needle, rather than the usual two*), k20 (22, 24, 26, 28, 30, 32), k2tog, turn. Last gusset st decreased.

Row 3: Make DS (*because the previous row ended with a decrease, you will have four strands up on the needle, rather than the usual two*), k to previous DS, turn.

Row 4: Make DS, k to previous DS, turn.

Row 5: Make DS, k to previous DS, turn.

Row 6: Make DS, k to previous DS, turn.

Continue as set, working 1 less stitch each row, until you have completed 16 (18, 18, 20, 20, 22, 24) rows, ending with a WS row.

With RS facing, you will have 7 (8, 8, 9, 9, 10, 11) DS to the right – between the start of the heel and your current position – and 8 (9, 9, 10, 10, 11, 12) DS to the left, before the end of the heel/start of the instep.

Final row (RS): Make DS, k across to last of heel stitches, (working into both legs of DS as before); for the final DS, work into all four legs, then M1R (this will be used to close the heel gap). This is the end of the heel stitches. Stop here.

Leg – Front Side/Instep

| Starting at start of instep stitches, you will be working only on the 22 (24, 26, 28, 30, 32, 34) sts of front side of the leg/instep.

Row 1 (RS): K to last instep st, turn.

Row 2 (WS): Make DS, k to first instep st, turn.

Row 3: Make DS, k to previous DS, turn.

Row 4: Make DS, k to previous DS, turn.

Continue as set, working 1 less stitch each row, until you have completed 8 (10, 10, 12, 12, 14, 14) rows, ending with a WS row.

| With RS facing, you will have 3 (4, 4, 5, 5, 6, 6) DS to the right – between the start of the instep and your current position – and 4 (5, 5, 6, 6, 7, 7) DS to the left, at the end of the row.

Final row (RS): Make DS, k across to last of instep stitches, (working into both legs of DS as before), M1R (this will be used to close the heel gap).

Edging

Transition round: Starting at the start of the heel stitches, knit into all four legs of the first DS, and then continue to knit across (working into both legs of DS as before) to last 2 sts (the last heel st and the increase); work SSK on the last heel stitch and the increase you worked (to close the heel gap). Continue, knitting across the instep, (working into both legs of DS as before) to last 2 sts, work SSK on the last instep stitch and the increase you worked (to close the heel gap). 44 (48, 52, 56, 60, 64, 68) sts.

Using the knitted-on method, CO 3 sts at the start of the round.

Leaving the sock sts on their current needles, use the larger needle to work the stitches as you go.

I-cord row: K2, k2tog-tbl; return these 3 sts back to left needle. 1 sock stitch bound off.

Work the *I-cord row* all the way around until only the 3 sts of the i-cord remain, slipping the sts back to the start of the needle as before. Cut yarn, leaving an 8 inch/20 cm tail. Thread the tail onto a yarn needle.

Join these stitches to the cast-on edge as follows:

1. Put the yarn needle through the back leg of the first live stitch, from the right to the left (as if to purl); leave the stitch on the knitting needle and pull the yarn through.
(Note: in the video, the first stitch is shown twisted, and the needle is positioned differently; if your stitch is not twisted, use this instruction.)
2. Go up to the cast-on edge, and put the yarn needle under the bottom of the 'v' of the first cast-on stitch, at the edge. Pull the yarn through so that the two edges snug up together.
3. Put the yarn needle through the first live stitch, from the left to the right, (as if to knit), slip the stitch off the knitting needle and pull the yarn through.
4. Put the yarn needle through the next live stitch, from the right to the left (as if to purl); leave the stitch on the knitting needle and pull the yarn through.
5. Go up to the cast-on edge, and put the yarn needle under the bottom of the 'v' of the second cast-on stitch, at the edge. Pull the yarn through so that the two edges snug up together.
6. Repeat step 3.
7. Repeat step 4.
8. Go up to the cast-on edge, and put the yarn needle under the bottom of the 'v' of the third cast-on stitch, at the edge. Pull the yarn through so that the two edges snug up together.
9. Repeat step 3: Put the yarn needle through the first live stitch, from the left to the right, (as if to knit), slip the stitch off the knitting needle and pull the yarn through.

Use the tip of the yarn needle to neaten the stitches, and then weave in the ends.

Finishing

Wash the sock, and lay it flat to dry. Do not pin or stretch.